

supplement to your retirement income, not the main source.



You can compute estimates of your future social security benefits and get information about the factors that influence your benefit amount by visiting the planner and calculator section of the Social Security Administration's website at www.ssa.gov.

There's been much discussion about whether social security is going broke as the baby boom generation (those born between 1946 and 1964) starts to hit normal retirement age. Sixty-five million baby boomers will put a strain on the system when they start collecting benefits, but some experts project that even then they'll be able to pay 75 percent of the benefits that workers have earned. This will probably equate to no more than 40 percent of your preretirement income and will fall far short of what you'll need for even the simplest lifestyle. Also to be taken into account is the fact that all of the social security "surplus" has been taken by the federal government to pay for other programs, including defense, and the interest on the national debt.